

The Crackup at the Heritage Foundation



REVIEW

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What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **The Nasdaq** recorded its worst week since President Trump unveiled his tariff plans in April. The index fell 3% while the Dow lost 1.2%. The S&P rose 1.6% for the week. **A1**

◆ **Pfizer** has agreed to buy weight-loss drug startup Metsera in a deal that could be worth more than \$10 billion, besting rival Novo Nordisk. **A1**

◆ **Six Flags** said it plans to invest in high-performing parks and could sell some less popular ones. **B10**

◆ **Wendy's** said it would close hundreds of locations through next year as consumers continue to pull back on spending at restaurants. **B10**

◆ **Comcast's Sky** is in talks to buy the broadcasting arm of Britain's ITV for \$21 billion. **B10**

◆ **Honda Motor** cut its earnings forecasts, flagging slumping car sales in China and Southeast Asia and a nearly \$1 billion drag due to a shortage of chips from Dutch supplier Nexperia. **B11**

◆ **IKEA** posted a sharp drop in earnings as tariffs, raw-material costs and price-cutting efforts all weighed on the its bottom line. **B11**

◆ **Sony** and **CBS** have resolved a legal fight over the business operations of "Wheel of Fortune" and "Jeopardy!" **B11**

World-Wide

◆ **President Trump** insisted that prices are coming down, a position at odds with government statistics, and said the notion that Republicans performed poorly in recent elections because of affordability concerns is a Democratic "con job." **A1**

◆ **Flight cancellations** across the U.S. could rise to 15%—or even 20%—if the government shutdown continues, Transportation Secretary Duffy said. **A3**

◆ **The Supreme Court** paused a lower court order that directed the Trump administration to fully fund SNAP for November. **A3**

◆ **Cornell** will pay \$60 million to settle the Trump administration's complaints alleging discrimination at the Ivy League school. **A6**

◆ **Senate Minority Leader** Schumer proposed extending healthcare subsidies for a year as part of a measure to reopen the government, but Republicans rejected the move. **A3**

◆ **Rep. Elise Stefanik** said she would seek the Republican nomination to challenge New York Democratic Gov. Kathy Hochul next year. **A5**

◆ **Despite weakening support** in the West, the global shift to clean energy is barreling ahead—driven largely by the emergence of China as a clean-tech superpower. **A7**

◆ **Died: James Watson**, co-discovered DNA structure, 97. **A2**

NOONAN

Take Mamdani seriously and literally **A13**

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More Cancellations Loom for Frustrated Fliers



HEADACHE: A passenger waits Friday at Newark Liberty International Airport in New Jersey as hundreds of flights were canceled across the country due to the government shutdown. Transportation Secretary Sean Duffy said cancellations could rise to 20%. **A3**

Trump Dismisses Affordability As Key Issue After GOP Losses

By ANNIE LINSKEY
AND MERIDITH MCGRAW

WASHINGTON—Republicans in Washington came away from this past week's elections with a clear take-away: focus on the high cost of living or risk big losses in next year's midterms.

President Trump isn't convinced.

The president said this past week that Republicans aren't

talking enough about his administration's successes, and he dismissed questions about voters' concerns about the economy. Most prices are on the downswing, he argued.

"Our energy costs are way down. Our groceries are way down. Everything is way down. And the press doesn't report it," Trump said this past week. "So, I don't want to hear about the affordability. Because right now, we're much less."

That is at odds with government statistics and the views of many voters, according to pollsters and analysts. The Labor Department reported last month that consumer prices rose 3% in September from a year earlier, the fastest pace since January. In surveys, voters have said the costs of housing, groceries and utility bills are unmanageable. Democratic candidates who focused on affordability came out on top in

Tuesday's elections, handily beating their GOP challengers.

In the Oval Office Friday, Trump lashed out at reporters for pressing him on the cost of living. The GOP president called Democrats' contention that affordability played a role in Tuesday's election a "con job," and he asked White House

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◆ **A look at where the GOP lost support..... A4**

Pfizer Set To Acquire Metsera in \$10 Billion Cash Deal

By JONATHAN D. ROCKOFF

Pfizer has agreed to buy weight-loss drug startup Metsera in a deal that could be worth more than \$10 billion, besting rival Novo Nordisk following a heated bidding war. Under the terms of the cash deal, Pfizer will pay \$65.60 a share upfront and a contingent value right worth up to \$20.65 a share, Metsera said Friday.

In September, Pfizer had agreed to buy Metsera for up to \$7.3 billion. But Novo Nordisk then took the unusual step of trying to outflank Pfizer, setting off a bidding war.

Pfizer said it expected to close the transaction after Metsera shareholders vote on the deal Thursday.

"We look forward to quickly leveraging the scale of our global clinical, manufacturing and commercial infrastructure to accelerate Metsera's portfolio and working to bring these important therapies to patients around the world," Pfizer said. Novo Nordisk didn't immediately respond to requests seeking comment.

Pfizer prevailed after increasing its bid by 5 cents a share, matching Novo Nordisk. *Please turn to page A6*

◆ **The unlikely duo about to cash in on deal..... B3**

EXCHANGE



CAREER KILLER

Bosses deliver a message: Use AI or you're fired. **B1**

Soybeans Caught In Trade Crossfire

U.S. farmers depend on sales to China, giving Beijing weapon in negotiations

By PATRICK THOMAS

After years of getting whipsawed by global politics, Illinois farmer Dean Buchholz thought he had seen it all. But even he was shocked when his soybean crop got caught up in a South American financial crisis.

Just days after the Trump administration pledged a \$20 billion loan to backstop the finances of Argentina under libertarian President

Javier Milei, China bought billions of dollars worth of soybeans from Argentina. The massive agriculture deal ricocheted through international markets, pressuring U.S. soybean prices and providing a bump to Argentina's currency.

In the middle of a Chinese trade war with Washington, Beijing and Buenos Aires had teamed up to show that the world could live without American soy-

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Their Daughter Invented a Game. It Took Over Their Lives.

* * *

What started as a project to get through Covid is now the family business; 'It got real.'

By PAUL BERGER

ATLANTIC HIGHLANDS, N.J.—Erich Arcement was standing outside his New Jersey home one morning last October when a truck driver called to ask what time his store opened for deliveries.

Arcement later directed a box truck up his curved driveway where he helped unload 3,000 board games his daughter Persy invented when she was eight.

"I'm like, 'Oh my God. Okay, now it got real,'" Arcement's

wife Nerina Garcia-Arcement said of the six pallet-loads of shrink-wrapped boxes. "How are we going to sell this?"

What began as a daddy-daughter project has taken over the Arcement family's lives.

"We are shipping, distributing, manufacturing," Arcement, who runs a small transportation consulting firm, said one Saturday at the dining table of his home near the Jersey shore. Piled next to him were dozens of pink and purple *Please turn to page A9*

IMAX Seen as Ticket To Box Office Success

By BEN FRITZ

Movie producer Neal Moritz recently flew to New York for his first pitch to the man who controls the screens everyone in Hollywood wants: the chief executive of IMAX.

Moritz connected his laptop to a conference room television to show Rich Gelfond and his team secret early visuals for "Sonic the Hedgehog 4," in hopes the movie could secure IMAX's supesize screens when it opens in the spring of 2027.

Such pilgrimages are increasingly common for Hollywood power players. "This is something that was

AI Boom Gets Dose Of Reality On Wall Street

Tech stocks drag the Nasdaq down amid worries of hype and stretched valuations

By SAM GOLDFARB
AND HANNAH ERIN LANG

The tech-heavy Nasdaq Composite Index, long buoyed by excitement over artificial intelligence, recorded its worst week since President Trump unveiled his "Liberation Day" plans to impose tariffs on the rest of the world.

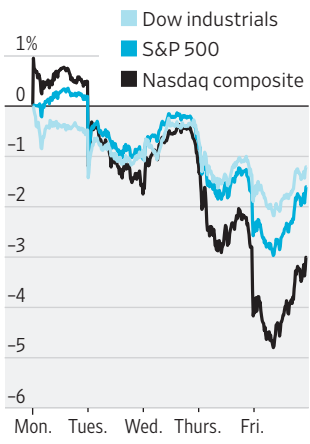
Some of the biggest beneficiaries of this year's market rally fell sharply amid concerns of overspending and overpromising on AI initiatives. While investors' confidence in the outlook for the economy and the AI boom has powered stocks to record highs, their faith is wavering.

Other perilous crosscurrents in the economy also had Wall Street on edge. The federal government shutdown dragged into its second month, halting the flow of economic data that might have eased investor anxiety. Instead, lofty stock valuations and private-sector surveys showing waning consumer sentiment and mounting job cuts added to the stress.

"Valuations are stretched," said Jack Ablin, chief investment strategist at Cresset Capital. "Just the slightest bit of bad news gets exaggerated...and good news is just not enough to move the needle because expectations are already pretty high."

The Nasdaq fell 0.2% on Friday. The index's weekly decline of 3% was its steepest since April. The S&P 500 ticked up 0.1% Friday but finished down 1.6% on the week. The Dow Jones Industrial Average added 0.2%, or 75 points, on Friday to end the *Please turn to page A2*

Index performance this past week



Source: FactSet